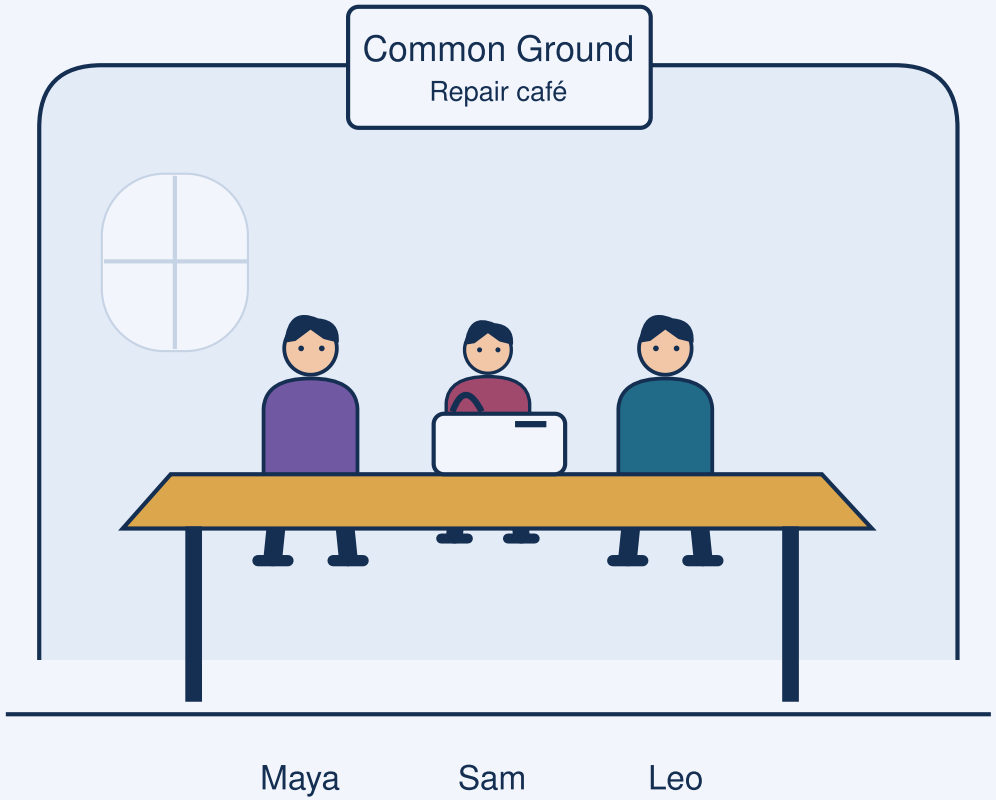
Chapter 10 · Story

A crash. A full room. A moment of hesitation.

An original story at the Common Ground repair café.



Who will do something? · c10s01

A fictional story. A real question about people.

What would you do?

Why could concerned bystanders hesitate?

A Concern disappears when groups become large.

B People may be uncertain and assume someone else will act.

C Hesitation proves nobody cares.

Suggested answer: B. Ambiguity and divided responsibility can both contribute.

Helping has several decision points.

- Notice and interpret the need.
- Accept responsibility; identify a safe action.
- Act with available skills and support.



Helping involves noticing, interpreting, responsibility, and safe action.

Make constructive action easier.

- Aggression: behavior intended to harm.
- De-escalation: lower threat and preserve safety.
- Cooperation: align goals, roles, and feedback.



Helping involves noticing, interpreting, responsibility, and safe action.

What can we really conclude?

Laboratory aggression measures are imperfect proxies for serious violence. Bystander findings vary with danger, relationships, and available support. Avoid universal slogans about crowds. For real emergencies, follow local guidance and your training; a social psychology explanation does not replace first-aid instruction. Assess practical changes by whether appropriate, safe help becomes more available.



Conceptual illustration; no research data are plotted.

Try the idea somewhere new.

Which preparation makes future help more likely?

A Tell everyone to be more caring.

B Assume the most senior person handles all incidents.

C Agree on response roles, training, and a call-for-help route.

Suggested answer: C. Preparation addresses ability and responsibility, not just intentions.

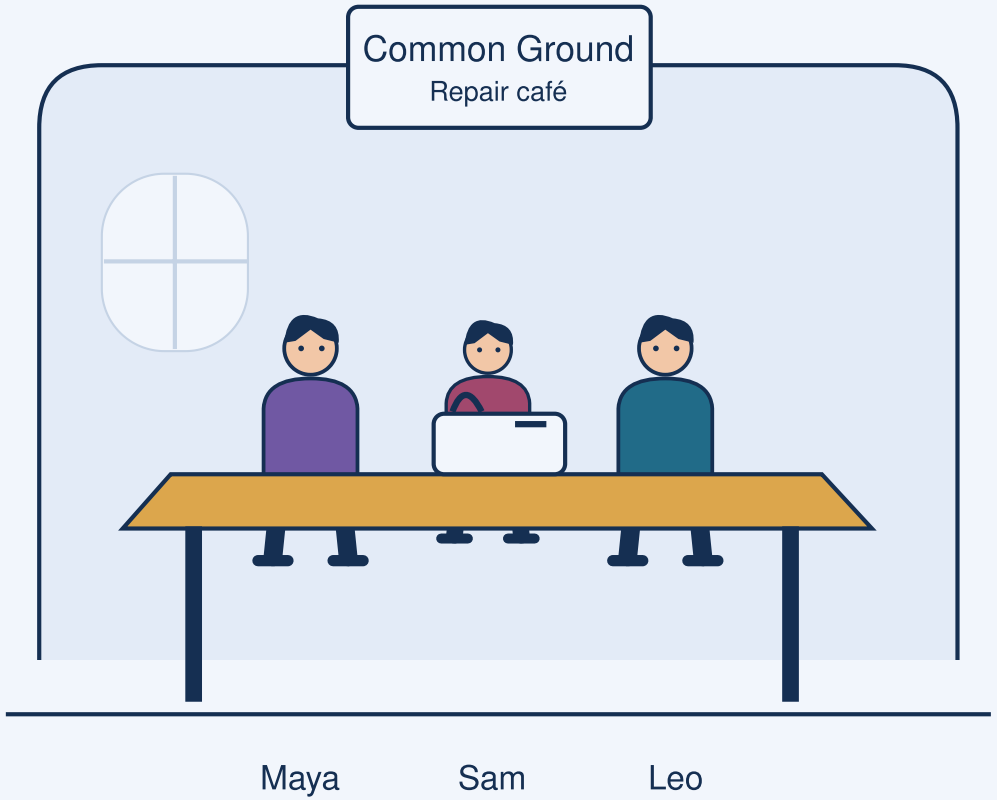
Close your notes. Explain it.

> Distinguish diffusion of responsibility from pluralistic ignorance.

> Apply two earlier chapters to an incident review.

1. Diffusion concerns who should act; pluralistic ignorance concerns interpreting others' reactions.

2. Separate observations from blame (1), compare causes (2), invite independent accounts (5), or assign clear roles (7).

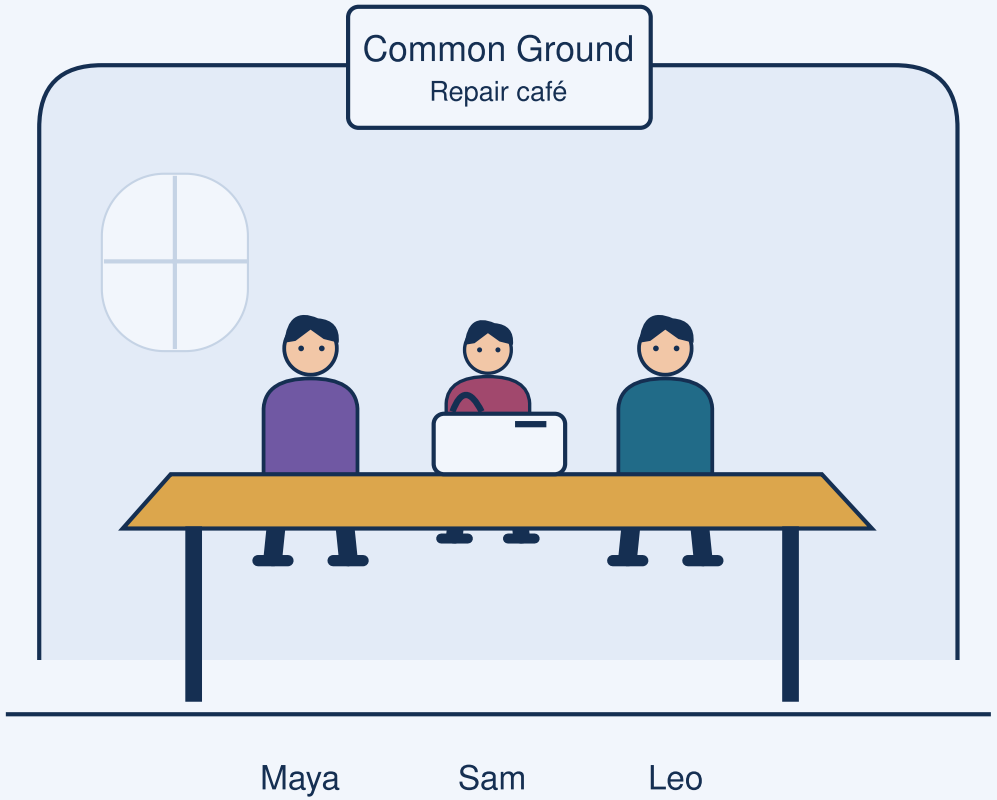


Maya, Sam and Leo at the repair café.

Carry one idea into your week.

Design a helping plan for a low-risk shared task: signal, named role, safe action, and feedback. Explain how context, evidence, influence, and group structure shape your plan.

Revisit tomorrow and in a week.
Explain it without notes, then use a different example.



Take the question into a different setting.